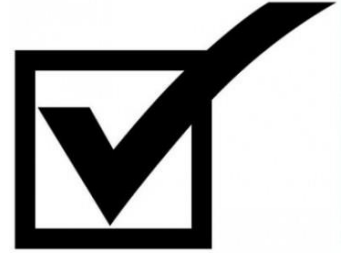




**BUSINESS
PROFESSIONALS**
of **AMERICA**
Giving Purpose to Potential



ETHICS & PROFESSIONALISM

(540)

NATIONAL 2023

FINAL

Presentation Points	_____ (140 points)
Specification Points	_____ (20 points)
TOTAL POINTS	_____ (160 points)

Preparation Time: 20 minutes

GENERAL GUIDELINES:

Failure to adhere to any of the following rules will result in disqualification:

1. Contestant must hand in this test booklet and all printouts if any.
2. No equipment, supplies, or materials other than those specified for this event are allowed in the testing area. No previous BPA tests and/or sample tests (handwritten, photocopied, or keyed) are allowed in the testing area.
3. Electronic devices will be monitored according to ACT standards.

DESCRIPTION:

Explore the application of ethical frameworks to various aspects used in business today.

NATIONAL FINAL SCENARIO KEY:

During her break, Trish was playing basketball with some fellow Digital Solutions' employees in the parking lot. During the pick-up game, which went way beyond her break time, she slipped and twisted her ankle. She was limping back to work in the shipping department after break. Her employer saw her limping and, thinking Trish had slipped on the job, told her to fill out an incident report. He also offered to take care of Trish's medical expenses and give her time off from work, even though Trish is still capable of performing her work duties.

- What are Trish's next steps and how will they potentially affect her professional and personal reputation?
- What, if any, responsibility do Trish's fellow basketball players have in this situation?
- What, if any, company ethics policies and/or procedures may be involved in this scenario?
- What are the possible consequences, including legal action, if Trish keeps quiet about what really happened and takes time off with medical benefits?

A contestant will be DISQUALIFIED for violations of the Copyright and Fair Use Guidelines.

Contestants who do not submit an entry that follows this topic will be disqualified.

Answers will vary, but may include the following from the *Ethics and Professionalism Resources Manual*:

- Page 3 - Open communication is conducting professional business with transparency and dual freedom to exchange information.
- Page 3- Equal opportunities is ensuring those around you and those you engage in business transactions are given the respect, honesty, and fairness needed to perform in the workplace.
- Page 3 - Digital Solutions' employees agree to uphold the following standards:
 - take responsibility for my actions, decisions, and obligations
 - make honest and transparent decisions which are good for all involved
 - present information in a clear and timely manner to all parties

- encourage actions, policies, and procedures which promote high standards for conduct and professionalism
- uphold and respect the laws that govern my work
- Page 5 – Personal ethics: a person’s ethics in their personal life will undoubtedly affect how they conduct business.
- Page 5 – Business ethics: Prevent exploitation, harassment, and intimidation in the workplace. It ensures that the organization abides by the law of the land. It is difficult to remain innocent if you make a habit of deceiving and exploiting people.
- Page 5 – Fairness is an important component of ethical business.
- Page 5 – Integrity is the foundation on which good commerce is built and involves holding to your principles even when it would be easier or more profitable to compromise them.
- Page 5 – Trustworthiness: neither you nor your business can succeed with a reputation of untrustworthiness.
- Page 5 – Values: a person’s moral code is integrated into his/her business ethics. A person uses his/her own personal values in the context of his/her business dealings.
- Page 6 – Paying respect to co-workers, oneself, and clients, being honest during any type of transaction, and taking responsibility for one's own actions is both ethical and professional. Today’s employees are looking for a workplace that exhibits positive ethical and professional values.
- Page 6 – The professionalism of an individual reflects on more than just him/herself. Not only can it build an individual’s self-esteem by gaining respect from others, it also reflects well on the company.
- Page 6 – Professionalism allows for heightened respect from clients, thereby opening greater lines of communication and potentially increased trust.
- Page 7 – Effective communication skills will give you an advantage over most of your colleagues. Knowing how to efficiently communicate your message will enable you to increase the amount of influence that you will have in dealing with your peers, supervisors, and subordinates.
- Page 8 – Punctuality – Being punctual is a very important aspect of professionalism. In a professional setting, people should always abide by the time and schedule prescribed by the organization.
- Page 9 – Confidentiality is critical in many professional engagements and is key to organizational risk management and both personal and professional liability.